accuracy could really get better. I've been working with this guy,' and I point to Mark Bawden, his face shocked to have been pointed out against the exhaustion of the day's work. 'It's made a massive difference to me, so that's how I'm going to go about being a better cricketer.' I wanted to acknowledge Bawden and the trip has been a real breakthrough in terms of the team's relationship with him – on the last day, we go on a huge hill climb and, throughout the course of this arduous final task, I see seven or eight of the team go up to Bawden and ask if they can be helped with something in their game. There's a real togetherness, a feeling of a shared ambition and will, beginning to ripple through the team.

Back at the campfire, people start talking and, gently, different gestures of gratitude in small speeches are thrown into the air, into the fire, alongside admissions of fear and how people are scared about failing for their families, that sometimes they don't feel like they are good enough. I really feel like, for a second, all of it is OK. That sheer vulnerability in front of people who have gone through the same thing you have, to be able to see each other – not as cricketers, and not even as the best of friends, but just as other people trying to achieve the same thing you are, tied together by coincidence and circumstance, suddenly with a deeper level of respect for each other.

Then I look at Andy Flower. He looks more broken than anybody there – a shivering wreck. This had been his idea and he's put himself through everything the team has, the entire staff have too. There's something in that, a shared suffering, no matter who you are and where you supposedly sit in the pecking order. It's a much deeper evolution of what a cricket team could give you and evolve to be, but nonetheless, it reminds me too of that team of adults I'd first joined in Burnley, where I'd felt safe and understood, where I'd been given purpose and value, where I'd really begun to understand who I was and who I could be. Some of the team take the bricks, keep them with them and pack them in their bags for the next Ashes tour to remind themselves of what they had put themselves through and what they were capable of going through. Next stop, Australia. Steven Finn never did get his Haribo back.